UPSC INDIAN POLITY

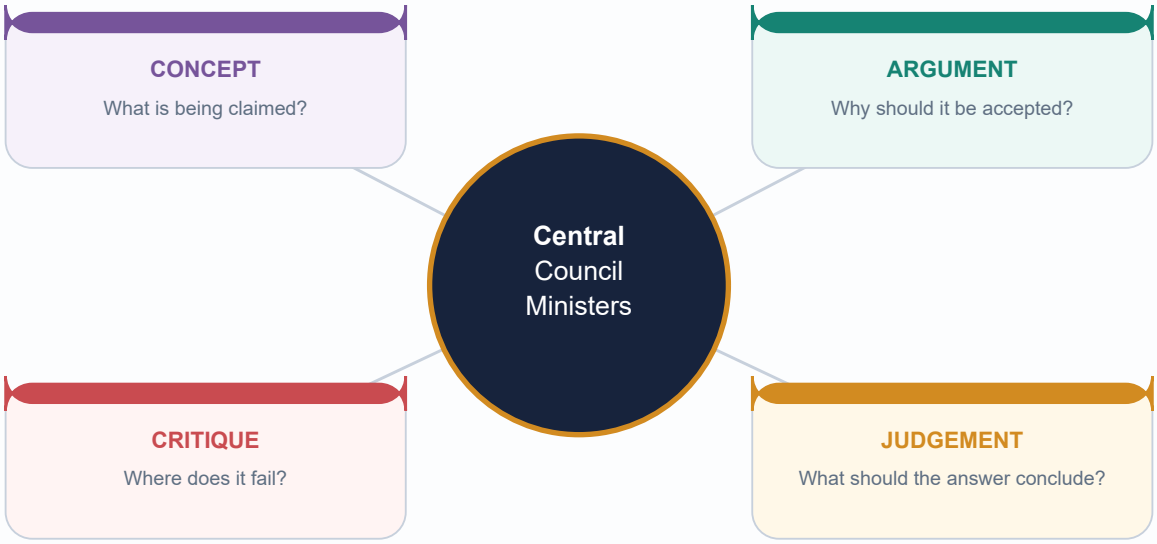
PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains

Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth

Sources: PM-and-Council-of-Ministers.md + 16_PM-and-Council-of-Ministers.md

Learning cards: 42



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Basic · **GS Paper:** GS-II · **Grounded in:** Laxmikant Ch. 19–21.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ book · □□ inference · □ current. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/16_PM-and-Council-of-Ministers.md — not required for any mark.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. book · □□ inference · □ current. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/16_PM-and-Council-of-Ministers.md — not required for any mark.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Value
PM	Real executive; **head of government**; leader of LS majority
Appointed by	President (Art 75) — no fixed procedure
May be from	**Either House** (Indira, Deve Gowda, Manmohan = Rajya Sabha)
Non-MP limit	**6 consecutive months** (Article 75(5))
CoM cap	**≤ 15% of total Lok Sabha membership**, including PM (91st Amdt, 2003)
Key articles	74 (aid & advise), 75 (ministers), 77, 78, 88
Responsible to	**Lok Sabha** (collective responsibility)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 The President is the *nominal* head; the **PM + Council of Ministers is the real executive**. **Art 74** — CoM aids & advises the President (advice **binding**, can't be questioned in court). **Art 75** — collective responsibility to the Lok Sabha: one no-confidence motion sinks the **whole** ministry.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

V

Dimension 1 The President is the nominal head; the PM + Council of Ministers is the real executive. Art 74 — CoM aids & advises the President (advice binding, c	**Dimension 2** PM's role tags: Morley = "primus inter pares" + "keystone of the cabinet arch"; Jennings = "the
Dimension 3 sun around which planets revolve"; Ambedkar = "if any office matches the US President, it's the PM."	**Dimension 4** CoM vs Cabinet: CoM = wider constitutional ministry (all ranks) Cabinet = smaller

STATIC THEORY

- **PM's role tags:** Morley = *"primus inter pares"* + *"keystone of the cabinet arch"*; Jennings = *"the

- sun around which planets revolve"*; Ambedkar* = "if any office matches the US President, it's the PM."*

- **CoM vs Cabinet:** CoM = wider constitutional ministry (all ranks) **Cabinet** = smaller

- Cabinet-rank decision core. Their actual sizes and meeting frequency vary; no permanent count is constitutional.

MEMORY HOOK

PM's role tags: Morley = *"primus inter pares"* + *"keystone of the cabinet arch"*; Jennings = *"the | CoM vs Cabinet: CoM = wider constitutional ministry (all ranks) Cabinet = smaller

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The President is the *nominal* head; the **PM + Council of Ministers is the real executive**. **Art 74** — CoM aids & advises the President (advice **binding**, can't be questioned in court). **Art 75** — collective responsibility to the Lok Sabha: one no-confidence motion sinks the **whole** ministry.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Three ranks of ministers

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Cabinet Ministers (top, in Cabinet) → **Ministers of State** (independent charge / attached) → **Deputy Ministers** (assist).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Cabinet Ministers (top, in Cabinet) → **Ministers of State** (independent charge / attached) → **Deputy Ministers** (assist).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Three ranks of ministers

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 91st Amdt 2003: ministers ≤ **15% of LS**; defector can't be a minister.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

V

Dimension 1 91st Amdt 2003: ministers ≤ 15% of LS; defector can't be a minister.	**Dimension 2** Art 88: ministers speak in either House, vote only in their own.
Dimension 3 PM's resignation/death = resignation of the entire CoM.	**Dimension 4** Cabinet Committees = extra-constitutional ministerial bodies under business-rule practice.

STATIC THEORY

- **Art 88:** ministers **speak in either House, vote only in their own**.

- PM's resignation/death = resignation of the **entire** CoM.

- **Cabinet Committees** = extra-constitutional ministerial bodies under business-rule practice.

- Their number, membership and chairs vary by notification; never freeze an old textbook list.

- **Kitchen Cabinet** = informal inner circle of the PM (very powerful under Indira Gandhi).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **91st Amdt 2003:** ministers ≤ **15% of LS**; defector can't be a minister.
2. **Art 88:** ministers **speak in either House, vote only in their own**.
3. PM's resignation/death = resignation of the **entire** CoM.
4. **Cabinet Committees** = extra-constitutional ministerial bodies under business-rule practice.
5. **Kitchen Cabinet** = informal inner circle of the PM (very powerful under Indira Gandhi).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation · □ Current link

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □□ The **Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS)** is the apex body that clears major defence/security decisions — watch for it in any national-security news. □□ The article-wise depth, the traps and the Mains angles are all held **in this file**. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/16_PM-and-Council-of-Ministers.md — not required for any mark.* □□ For how portfolios become organised departments, files, consultations, Cabinet decisions and implementation, use Ministries-and-Departments-of-Government.md.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ Current link

HIGH

Foundation · Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

*Purpose: make this Core file independently answer directive-sensitive GS-II questions on the appointment of the Prime Minister, collective and individual responsibility, the Cabinet–Council distinction and the "prime-ministerial government" debate — without opening Advanced. This file is the folder's **owner of collective-responsibility answers**.*

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

HIGH

Foundation · 6.1 Demand and directive map

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Demand family	Typical directive signals	Answer spine to use
Collective responsibility	"bedrock of parliamentary government", "coalition dilution", Examine	Art 75(3) → no-confidence sinks whole CoM → Cabinet solidarity → coalition-era caveat → verdict
Individual responsibility	"ministerial accountability", "pleasure doctrine", Discuss	Art 75(2) pleasure → PM's advice removes → contrast with collective → verdict
Appointment of PM	"hung house", "President's discretion", Comment	Art 75 (no procedure) → majority-leader convention → hung-house/sudden-death discretion → floor test
Cabinet vs Council	"CoM ≠ Cabinet", Prelims + Distinguish	Art 74/75 CoM → Cabinet as inner body → 44th Amdt "Cabinet" in Art 352 → committees
Prime-ministerial government	"PM has eclipsed the Cabinet", Critically examine	Concentrating tools → collegial checks → coalition/federal limits → qualified verdict
Ministerial size / ranks	"15% cap", "three ranks", Prelims	91st Amdt Art 75(1A) → ranks → defection bar (Art 75(1B))

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.1 Demand and directive map

HIGH

Foundation · 6.2 Qualified thesis options

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Collective responsibility is the load-bearing wall of Indian parliamentary government — Article 75(3) makes the ministry a single body that stands or falls together — yet the coalition era has turned a doctrine of solidarity into a daily negotiation.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

6.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS: RECALL MAP

6.2 Qualified thesis options

V

Dimension 1 Collective responsibility is the load-bearing wall of Indian parliamentary government — Article 75(3) makes the ministry a single body that stands or	**Dimension 2** The Prime Minister is "primus inter pares" only on paper; control of portfolios, the dissolution recommendation and the channel to the President make
Dimension 3 The 91st Amendment tried to convert the ministry from an instrument of patronage into a disciplined executive by capping its size and barring defector	**Dimension 4** India has moved toward prime-ministerial government in fact without amending the cabinet form in law; whether that is dominance or leadership depends

STATIC THEORY

- The Prime Minister is "primus inter pares" only on paper; control of portfolios, the dissolution recommendation and the channel to the President make him the keystone of the arch, but allies, the Cabinet and the courts keep the arch from becoming a pillar.

- The 91st Amendment tried to convert the ministry from an instrument of patronage into a disciplined executive by capping its size and barring defectors, but the same anti-defection logic that stabilises governments also hollows out the backbench.

- India has moved toward prime-ministerial government in fact without amending the cabinet form in law; whether that is dominance or leadership depends on whether the majority is single-party or coalitional.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.2 Qualified thesis options

HIGH

Foundation · 6.3 Mark-scaled structures

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Marks	Architecture	Evidence load
10	Thesis → the relevant provision → one mechanism/example → one limitation → verdict	2–3 units, at least one Article
15	Thesis → provision → responsibility/appointment mechanism → named instances → coalition/federal caveat → verdict	5–6 units
20	Thesis → constitutional scheme (Art 74/75/77/78) → responsibility in full → Cabinet system → prime-ministerial debate → reform/coalition variation → graded verdict	6–8 units + a text-vs-practice paragraph

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.3 Mark-scaled structures

HIGH

Foundation · 6.4 Bank A — Collective and individual responsibility (this file's owned demand)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Claim	Named anchor	Mechanism / significance	Limitation / caution
The ministry is collectively answerable to the popular House	□ **Art 75(3)**	The CoM is **collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha**; a passed **no-confidence motion forces the entire ministry** (including RS ministers) to resign	The **Rajya Sabha cannot remove** the ministry; only the LS can
Cabinet decisions bind every minister	□ **Cabinet-solidarity convention**	A minister who cannot defend a Cabinet decision must resign	□ **Ambedkar tendered resignation in 1951** over the Hindu Code Bill issue — dissent means exit, not public opposition
Ministers hold office individually at pleasure	□ **Art 75(2)**	Ministers hold office **during the pleasure of the President**; the President removes a minister **on the PM's advice**	Individual responsibility is weaker in practice — the PM, not Parliament, is the effective enforcer
The ministry's advice is legally insulated	□ **Art 74(2)**	Whether and what advice the CoM gave the President **cannot be inquired into by courts**	The inquiry bar does not immunise every resulting executive act from review
The PM is the hinge of communication	□ **Art 78**	The PM communicates CoM decisions to the President and furnishes information he seeks	Makes the PM the sole authoritative channel between the ministry and the head of State
Ministers may speak widely but vote narrowly	□ **Art 88**	A minister may **speak and take part in either House** and its committees	**Votes only in the House of which he is a member**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.4 Bank A — Collective and individual responsibility (this file's owned demand)

HIGH

Foundation · 6.4 Bank A — Collective and individual responsibility (this file's owned demand)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Answer rule: a "collective responsibility" question is best answered by pairing **Art 75(3)** (the rule) against the **coalition-era caveat** (the practice), then judging whether solidarity survives.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.4 Bank A — Collective and individual responsibility (this file's owned demand)

HIGH

Foundation · 6.5 Bank B — Appointment of the PM and the hung-house convention

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: the Constitution leaves the PM's appointment to convention, which is why it matters most when convention is silent. **Provision:** □ **Art 75(1)** — the PM is "appointed by the President"; **no detailed selection procedure** is prescribed. **Mechanism:** by convention the President appoints the recognised leader capable of commanding a Lok Sabha majority. **Situational judgment arises** where no claimant has a clear majority or an incumbent dies before a successor is settled; it is bounded by objective support material and a prompt floor test. **Illustrations:** Charan Singh (1979), Rajiv Gandhi (1984) and Vajpayee (1996). **Limitation/status:** □ *S. P. Anand v. H. D. Deve Gowda* (1996) accepted a non-member PM subject to Article 75(5); the PM may be from **either House**.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Floor-test discipline:** □□ the constitutional test of majority is a **vote on the floor**, not the President's subjective assessment — the same rule the courts apply to Governors and Chief Ministers.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim: the Constitution leaves the PM's appointment to convention, which is why it matters most when convention is silent. **Provision: Art 75(1)** — the PM is "appointed by the President"; **no detailed selection procedure** is prescribed. **Mechanism:** by convention the President appoints the recognised leader capable of commanding a Lok Sabha majority. **Situational judgment arises** where no claimant has a clear majority or an incumbent dies before a successor is settled; it is bounded by objective support material and a prompt floor test. **Illustrations:** Charan Singh (1979), Rajiv Gandhi (1984) and Vajpayee (1996). **Limitation/status:** *S. P. Anand v. H. D. Deve Gowda* (1996) accepted a non-member PM subject to Article 75(5); the PM may be from **either House**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.5 Bank B — Appointment of the PM and the hung-house convention

HIGH

Foundation · 6.6 Bank C — Council, Cabinet, committees and the PMO

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Body	Named anchor	Mechanism	Caution
Council of Ministers	Art 74, 75	Wider body containing ministers of the ranks currently appointed; carries collective responsibility	Its actual strength varies within Article 75(1A)'s ceiling
Cabinet	Cabinet-rank inner core	Deliberates and decides major policy and directs the wider ministry	Article 352(3), inserted by the 44th Amendment, expressly defines Cabinet for emergency advice
Three ranks	Convention	**Cabinet Ministers** → **Ministers of State** (independent charge/attached) → **Deputy Ministers**	A "Deputy PM" is **descriptive only** (SC upheld Devi Lal's 1990 oath)
Cabinet Committees	**Business-rule practice (extra-constitutional)**	Standing or ad hoc ministerial bodies that specialise and coordinate Cabinet work	Number, membership and chairs are notification-sensitive; check the dated official Cabinet Secretariat document
Kitchen Cabinet	Convention (extra-constitutional)	Informal inner circle of the PM + a few trusted colleagues; powerful under **Indira Gandhi**	Not a decision body known to law
Prime Minister's Office (PMO)	**Non-constitutional / non-statutory** staff agency	Headed by the **Principal Secretary to the PM**; processes matters needing the PM's attention	**Not** a constitutional decision-maker and **not** the Cabinet Secretariat

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.6 Bank C — Council, Cabinet, committees and the PMO

HIGH

Foundation · 6.6 Bank C — Council, Cabinet, committees and the PMO

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

91st Amdt (2003): □ total ministers **incl. the PM ≤ 15% of the Lok Sabha's** strength (**Art 75(1A)**); a member **disqualified for defection** is barred from ministership (**Art 75(1B)**).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Art 77 (business of government):** □ all executive action of the Government of India is expressed to be taken **in the President's name**, and the President makes rules for the **convenient transaction and allocation of business** among ministers (the Allocation/Transaction of Business Rules) — the constitutional bridge from the Council to organised departments (owner: Ministries-and-Departments-of-Government.md).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 91st Amdt (2003): total ministers **incl. the PM ≤ 15% of the Lok Sabha's** strength (**Art 75(1A)**); a member **disqualified for defection** is barred from ministership (**Art 75(1B)**).

2. Art 77 (business of government): all executive action of the Government of India is expressed to be taken **in the President's name**, and the President makes rules for the **convenient transaction and allocation of business** among ministers (the Allocation/Transaction of Business Rules) — the constitutional bridge from the Council to organised departments (owner: Ministries-and-Departments-of-Government.md).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.6 Bank C — Council, Cabinet, committees and the PMO

HIGH

Foundation · 6.7 Bank D — The "prime-ministerial government" debate (evidence and counter-evidence)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Concentrating evidence (PM-dominance)	Collegial / limiting counter-evidence
□ PM **allocates and reshuffles portfolios** and can force a minister's exit	□ **Collective responsibility (Art 75(3))** keeps the ministry a joint body
□ PM's **resignation/death dissolves the whole CoM**	□ **Coalition allies** exercise a real veto over policy and personnel
□ PM is the **sole channel to the President (Art 78)** and chairs key Cabinet Committees	□ **Federal and regional** pressures and State governments constrain the Centre
□ PM recommends **Lok Sabha dissolution** and leads the ruling party	□ **Judicial review** (Art 74(2) insulation aside) checks executive excess
□□ Tags: **Ambedkar** (PM = US-President analogue), **Morley** ("keystone of the cabinet arch"), **Jennings** ("the sun around which planets revolve"), **Laski** ("pivot of the machinery")	□□ **Anti-defection + Parliament's scrutiny** (questions, committees, no-confidence) preserve a floor of accountability

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.7 Bank D — The "prime-ministerial government" debate (evidence and counter-evidence)

HIGH

Foundation · 6.7 Bank D — The "prime-ministerial government" debate (evidence and counter-evidence)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Analytical use: this two-column bank answers any "prime-ministerial vs cabinet government" demand; the verdict turns on **single-party vs coalition** majority.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Cross-cutting support:** for **2024 · GS-II · Q3** (growth of the cabinet system marginalising parliamentary supremacy) this file supplies cabinet agenda-control, collective responsibility and whip effects; the complete route is owned by Parliamentary-System.md, with scrutiny correctives in Parliament.md.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.7 Bank D — The "prime-ministerial government" debate (evidence and counter-evidence)

HIGH

Foundation · 6.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Why collective responsibility disciplines:** the "resign together" rule (Art 75(3)) plus the **party whip** and **Cabinet secrecy** create a unified executive front that Parliament can hold to account as one — the incentive is solidarity, enforced by the fear of collapse.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

6.8 MECHANISM, INSTITUTIONAL INCENTIVES AND CONSEQUENCES: RECALL MAP

6.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

V

Dimension 1 □□ Why collective responsibility disciplines: the "resign together" rule (Art 75(3)) plus the party whip and Cabinet secrecy create a unified executiv	**Dimension 2** □□ Why the PM accumulates power: control of portfolios, the dissolution threat, the Art 78 channel and party leadership give the PM structural leverag
Dimension 3 □□ Consequence of the 91st Amdt: capping ministry size curbed "jumbo councils" and patronage, but the defection bar tied ministership to party discipl	

STATIC THEORY

- □□ **Why the PM accumulates power:** control of portfolios, the dissolution threat, the Art 78 channel and party leadership give the PM structural leverage the Constitution never enumerates — office, not text, concentrates power.

- □□ **Consequence of the 91st Amdt:** capping ministry size curbed "jumbo councils" and patronage, but the defection bar tied ministership to party discipline, strengthening the leadership against the backbench.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

HIGH

Foundation · 6.9 Criticism, counter-argument and variation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Dilution critique: □□ in coalitions allies dissent publicly and bargain portfolios, so collective responsibility is honoured more in form than in substance.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

6.9 CRITICISM, COUNTER-ARGUMENT AND VARIATION: RECALL MAP

6.9 Criticism, counter-argument and variation

V

Dimension 1 Dilution critique: □□ in coalitions allies dissent publicly and bargain portfolios, so collective responsibility is honoured more in form than in subs	**Dimension 2** Counter: □□ even coalitions fall as a body on a lost confidence vote, so the legal rule of collective responsibility is intact even where the politica
Dimension 3 Federal/coalition variation: □□ prime-ministerial dominance is strongest under a single-party majority and weakest under a fractured mandate; the same	**Dimension 4** Implementation constraint: □□ individual ministerial responsibility is weakly enforced — resignations for departmental failure are rare, and the PM, n

STATIC THEORY

- **Counter:** □□ even coalitions fall as a body on a lost confidence vote, so the **legal** rule of collective responsibility is intact even where the **political** convention frays.

- **Federal/coalition variation:** □□ prime-ministerial dominance is strongest under a single-party majority and weakest under a fractured mandate; the same office looks presidential in one Parliament and brokered in the next.

- **Implementation constraint:** □□ individual ministerial responsibility is weakly enforced — resignations for departmental failure are rare, and the PM, not Parliament, is the real disciplinary authority.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.9 Criticism, counter-argument and variation

HIGH

Foundation · 6.10 Verdict scaffolds

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Collective-responsibility verdict: "Article 75(3) still makes the ministry one body in law; the coalition era has made it many voices in practice, but the confidence of the Lok Sabha remains the single thread on which the whole ministry hangs."

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

6.10 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS: RECALL MAP

6.10 Verdict scaffolds

V

Dimension 1 Collective-responsibility verdict: "Article 75(3) still makes the ministry one body in law; the coalition era has made it many voices in practice, but	**Dimension 2** Appointment verdict: "The President's discretion in appointing a PM is dormant under a decisive verdict and decisive under a hung one, but it always e
Dimension 3 Prime-ministerial-government verdict: "India has prime-ministerial government when the PM has a majority and cabinet government when he does not; the	

STATIC THEORY

- **Appointment verdict:** "The President's discretion in appointing a PM is dormant under a decisive verdict and decisive under a hung one, but it always ends at the same place — a floor test, not a Raj Bhavan opinion."

- **Prime-ministerial-government verdict:** "India has prime-ministerial government when the PM has a majority and cabinet government when he does not; the form is constant, the reality is arithmetic."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.10 Verdict scaffolds

HIGH

Foundation · 6.11 Prelims close-option distinctions

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair / routed demand	Correct discrimination
Minister without legislature membership + defection (2020 Q19)	□ A **non-member can be a minister** but must become a member of either House **within six consecutive months** (Art 75(5)); a person **disqualified for defection is barred** from ministership (Art 75(1B))
Ministerial categories + council size (2022 Q14)	□ **Three ranks** — Cabinet, Minister of State, Deputy; total ministers **incl. PM ≤ 15% of the Lok Sabha** (91st Amdt, Art 75(1A)) — **not** 15% of both Houses
CoM vs Cabinet	□ CoM is the wider constitutional ministry; the **Cabinet** is its smaller Cabinet-rank decision core; neither has a permanently fixed actual size
"Cabinet" in the Constitution	□ Absent from the original text; inserted by the **44th Amdt** into **Art 352**
Where a minister votes	□ Speaks in either House (Art 88) but **votes only in his own**
15% cap base	□ **Lok Sabha** strength, not both Houses
Cabinet Committee chairs	□ Notification-sensitive; do not infer a universal chairmanship rule from an old list

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.11 Prelims close-option distinctions

HIGH

Foundation · 6.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

 The **15% cap is on the Lok Sabha's** strength (91st Amdt), never on both Houses combined. **"Cabinet" is not in the original Constitution**; it entered via the **44th Amdt** in **Art 352** — do not claim it was there in 1950. Cabinet Committees and the **Kitchen Cabinet** are **extra-constitutional**; the **PMO** is **non-constitutional/non-statutory** — none is a body "created by the Constitution".

INTRO & ORIGIN

 A **non-MP may be PM/minister for six months only** (Art 75(5)); do not say "never".

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

6.12 FACTUAL-RISK AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

6.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

V

Dimension 1 A non-MP may be PM/minister for six months only (Art 75(5)); do not say "never".	**Dimension 2** Scholarly tags (Morley, Jennings, Laski, Ambedkar) are characterisations, not constitutional text — attribute them, don't assert them as law.
Dimension 3 "Deputy Prime Minister" is descriptive, with no distinct constitutional powers (SC on Devi Lal's 1990 oath).	**Dimension 4** Collective responsibility is Art 75(3) (to the Lok Sabha); individual responsibility is Art 75(2) (pleasure) — keep the clause numbers distinct.

STATIC THEORY

- Scholarly tags (Morley, Jennings, Laski, Ambedkar) are **characterisations**, not constitutional text — attribute them, don't assert them as law.

- "Deputy Prime Minister" is **descriptive**, with no distinct constitutional powers (SC on Devi Lal's 1990 oath).

- Collective responsibility is **Art 75(3)** (to the Lok Sabha); individual responsibility is **Art 75(2)** (pleasure) — keep the clause numbers distinct.

- less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. A **non-MP may be PM/minister for six months only** (Art 75(5)); do not say "never".

2. Collective responsibility is **Art 75(3)** (to the Lok Sabha); individual responsibility is **Art 75(2)** (pleasure) — keep the clause numbers distinct.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 6.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

Foundation · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	Prelims GS-I	19	Minister appointment without legislature membership and disqualification	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	14	Ministerial categories and council size in Union Government	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Foundation · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Status: *Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md.* ***Answer-key rule:*** *The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.* ***Years represented:*** *2020, 2022* ***Paper(s):*** *Prelims GS-I* ***Routed question demands:*** *2*

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Foundation · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Minister appointment without legislature membership and disqualification

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 Minister appointment without legislature membership and disqualification	**Dimension 2** Ministerial categories and council size in Union Government
Dimension 3 The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not cl	**Dimension 4** less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

STATIC THEORY

- Ministerial categories and council size in Union Government

- The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

HIGH

Foundation · Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Responsible-executive spine: *Article 74 creates the Prime-Minister-headed Council that aids and advises the President; Article 75 separately controls appointment, pleasure, collective responsibility, oaths and the six-month rule. Article 77 controls formal executive action and business rules; Article 78 makes the Prime Minister the constitutional information channel to the President.* ***Appointment and confidence:*** *the President appoints the person most likely to command Lok Sabha confidence. A decisive majority leaves no personal choice; a hung House permits bounded judgment tested promptly on the floor. The Prime Minister may belong to either House or remain a non-member only for six consecutive months under Article 75(5).* ***Responsibility firewall:*** *Article 75(3) collective responsibility is owed only to the Lok Sabha and makes the ministry stand or fall together. Article 75(2) individual pleasure is normally enforced on the Prime Minister's advice. Political, individual and legal responsibility are not synonyms; Article 74(2) protects advice from inquiry but not every resulting executive act from review.* ***Ministry size and defection:*** *Article 75(1A), inserted by the Ninety-first Amendment, caps all Union ministers including the Prime Minister at fifteen per cent of Lok Sabha strength. Article 75(1B) separately bars a disqualified defector from ministership for the stated period.* ***Institution map:*** *the Council is the wider constitutional ministry; Cabinet is its smaller decision core and is expressly defined for Article 352(3). Cabinet Committees arise under business-rule practice; the Cabinet Secretariat and PMO are administrative staff institutions; a kitchen cabinet is informal. None of the last four may be treated as a constitutional substitute for the Council.* ***Business machinery:*** *the Government of India (Allocation of Business) Rules, 1961 distribute subjects among ministries; the Transaction of Business Rules, 1961 prescribe decision, consultation and Cabinet routes. Authentication under Article 77 does not erase ministerial responsibility or judicial review of the underlying legality.* ***Prime-ministerial government:*** *portfolio control, party leadership, Cabinet agenda, dissolution advice and the Article 78 channel concentrate power. Cabinet deliberation, coalition arithmetic, federal politics, Parliament, elections and judicial review qualify rather than abolish that concentration.* ***Continuity and caretaker control:*** *resignation or death of the Prime Minister ends the ministry politically, while Article 74 requires constitutional continuity until a successor assumes office. Caretaker restraint is convention, not a separate codified constitutional government.* ***Current control:*** *official PM India identifies Narendra Modi as Prime Minister. Cabinet Secretariat continues to publish the two 1961 business-rule sets and dated Cabinet-Committee compositions; committee membership and chairs must never be frozen beyond the cited notification.* ***Four-ledger/PYQ control:*** *every routed 2018-2026 demand was checked against constitutional text, the complete Basic owner, cross-owner boundaries and verified papers. Topic 11 retains the full parliamentary-system comparison; Topic 17 owns detailed parliamentary procedure.*

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

HIGH

Advanced · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-II	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 19–21 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.	**Dimension 4** Companion: basic/PM-and-Council-of-Ministers.md.

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 19–21 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.

- *Companion: basic/PM-and-Council-of-Ministers.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced · PART A — THE PRIME MINISTER (Art 75, 78)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of PART A — THE PRIME MINISTER (Art 75, 78).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — THE PRIME MINISTER (Art 75, 78)

HIGH

Advanced · Appointment □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ No specific procedure — **Art 75:** PM "appointed by the President." Convention: President appoints the recognised leader capable of commanding a Lok Sabha majority. Presidential judgment becomes relevant where no claimant has a clear majority or an incumbent dies before a successor is settled, but objective support material and a prompt floor test bound that judgment. **Charan Singh (1979)** and **Vajpayee (1996)** illustrate the difference between appointment and proved confidence. □ *S. P. Anand v. H. D. Deve Gowda* (1996) accepted a non-member PM subject to the **six-month** rule. □ The PM may be from **either House**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. No specific procedure — **Art 75:** PM "appointed by the President." Convention: President appoints the recognised leader capable of commanding a Lok Sabha majority. Presidential judgment becomes relevant where no claimant has a clear majority or an incumbent dies before a successor is settled, but objective support material and a prompt floor test bound that judgment. **Charan Singh (1979)** and **Vajpayee (1996)** illustrate the difference between appointment and proved confidence. *S. P. Anand v. H. D. Deve Gowda* (1996) accepted a non-member PM subject to the **six-month** rule. The PM may be from **either House**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Appointment □

HIGH

Advanced · Oath, term, salary

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ President administers oaths of **office and secrecy**. **Term not fixed** — holds office during the **pleasure of the President** (but can't be dismissed while he holds LS majority). Salary = that of an MP

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- sumptuary allowance etc.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. President administers oaths of **office and secrecy**. **Term not fixed** — holds office during the **pleasure of the President** (but can't be dismissed while he holds LS majority). Salary = that of an MP

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Oath, term, salary

HIGH

Advanced · Powers & functions □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Domain	Highlights
□ **Council of Ministers**	Recommends ministers; **allocates/reshuffles portfolios**; can force a minister's resignation; chairs CoM; his **resignation/death dissolves the entire CoM**
□ **President**	Principal **channel of communication (Art 78)**; advises on appointments (AG, CAG, UPSC, ECs, FC)
□ **Parliament**	Advises on summoning/proroguing; can recommend **LS dissolution** anytime; announces policies
□ **Other**	Chairman of **NITI Aayog**, National Integration Council, Inter-State Council, National Water Resources Council; chief spokesman; crisis manager; leader of the ruling party

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Powers & functions □

HIGH

Advanced · Powers & functions □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Ambedkar:** "If any functionary is to be compared with the US President, it is the **PM**, not the President." Role tags: **Lord Morley** — "primus inter pares" & "keystone of the cabinet arch"; **Jennings** — "a **sun** around which planets revolve"; **Laski** — "pivot of the machinery"; **Munro** — "captain of the ship of state."

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Ambedkar: "If any functionary is to be compared with the US President, it is the **PM**, not the President." Role tags: **Lord Morley** — "primus inter pares" & "keystone of the cabinet arch"; **Jennings** — "a **sun** around which planets revolve"; **Laski** — "pivot of the machinery"; **Munro** — "captain of the ship of state."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Powers & functions □

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — CENTRAL COUNCIL OF MINISTERS (Art 74, 75, 77, 78, 88)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of PART B — CENTRAL COUNCIL OF MINISTERS (Art 74, 75, 77, 78, 88).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — CENTRAL COUNCIL OF MINISTERS (Art 74, 75, 77, 78, 88)

HIGH

Advanced · Constitutional provisions □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Art 74:** CoM headed by PM to aid & advise the President (advice **binding** post-42nd/44th Amdts; advice **not inquirable** by courts). □ **Art 75:** ministers appointed by President on PM's advice; **91st Amdt (2003):** total ministers **≤ 15% of Lok Sabha** strength, and a member **disqualified for defection** can't be a minister; **6-month** non-MP rule; collective responsibility to the **Lok Sabha**. □ **Art 77:** business in President's name. □ **Art 88:** ministers may **speak in either House** but **vote only in their own**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Art 74: CoM headed by PM to aid & advise the President (advice **binding** post-42nd/44th Amdts; advice **not inquirable** by courts). **Art 75:** ministers appointed by President on PM's advice; **91st Amdt (2003):** total ministers **≤ 15% of Lok Sabha** strength, and a member **disqualified for defection** can't be a minister; **6-month** non-MP rule; collective responsibility to the **Lok Sabha**. **Art 77:** business in President's name. **Art 88:** ministers may **speak in either House** but **vote only in their own**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Constitutional provisions □

HIGH

Advanced · Responsibility □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Collective responsibility (Art 75)** — bedrock; CoM answerable to the **Lok Sabha**; a no-confidence motion forces **all** ministers (incl. RS ones) to resign; Cabinet decisions **bind all ministers** (dissent → resign; e.g. **Ambedkar tendered resignation in 1951 over the Hindu Code Bill issue**). □ **Individual responsibility** — ministers hold office during President's pleasure (removed on PM's advice). □ **No legal responsibility** — unlike Britain, no counter-signature requirement; courts can't probe ministerial advice.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Collective responsibility (Art 75) — bedrock; CoM answerable to the **Lok Sabha**; a no-confidence motion forces **all** ministers (incl. RS ones) to resign; Cabinet decisions **bind all ministers** (dissent → resign; e.g. **Ambedkar tendered resignation in 1951 over the Hindu Code Bill issue**). **Individual responsibility** — ministers hold office during President's pleasure (removed on PM's advice). **No legal responsibility** — unlike Britain, no counter-signature requirement; courts can't probe ministerial advice.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Responsibility □

HIGH

Advanced · Composition & CoM vs Cabinet □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Council of Ministers	Cabinet
Wider constitutional ministry; actual size varies within Article 75(1A)	Smaller Cabinet-rank decision core; actual size varies
Carries collective responsibility to Lok Sabha	Deliberates and decides major policy
□ Powers "in theory"	Exercises powers in practice; **directs** the CoM

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Composition & CoM vs Cabinet □

HIGH

Advanced · Composition & CoM vs Cabinet □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Three ranks: **Cabinet Ministers** (head major ministries, attend Cabinet), **Ministers of State** (independent charge OR attached; not in Cabinet), **Deputy Ministers** (assist, no independent charge). Also parliamentary secretaries (largely defunct since 1967) & occasional **Deputy PM** (*descriptive only* — SC upheld Devi Lal's 1990 oath).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Kitchen/Inner Cabinet** — informal body of PM + a few trusted colleagues (+ outsiders); very powerful under **Indira Gandhi**; exists in USA/UK too.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Three ranks: **Cabinet Ministers** (head major ministries, attend Cabinet), **Ministers of State** (independent charge OR attached; not in Cabinet), **Deputy Ministers** (assist, no independent charge). Also parliamentary secretaries (largely defunct since 1967) & occasional **Deputy PM** (*descriptive only* — SC upheld Devi Lal's 1990 oath).

2. Kitchen/Inner Cabinet — informal body of PM + a few trusted colleagues (+ outsiders); very powerful under **Indira Gandhi**; exists in USA/UK too.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Composition & CoM vs Cabinet □

HIGH

Advanced · PART C — CABINET COMMITTEES □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Extra-constitutional** ministerial bodies under business-rule practice; they may be **standing or ad hoc** and specialise, coordinate and accelerate Cabinet work subject to the formal system of collective responsibility. Their number, names, membership and chairs vary by notification. The official Cabinet Secretariat composition document dated **27 July 2026** must control any present-tense claim; no old count or universal chairmanship rule should be memorised. □ **Groups of Ministers (GoMs)** — ad hoc coordination bodies; **2nd ARC** urged selective use with time limits.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Extra-constitutional ministerial bodies under business-rule practice; they may be **standing or ad hoc** and specialise, coordinate and accelerate Cabinet work subject to the formal system of collective responsibility. Their number, names, membership and chairs vary by notification. The official Cabinet Secretariat composition document dated **27 July 2026** must control any present-tense claim; no old count or universal chairmanship rule should be memorised. **Groups of Ministers (GoMs)** — ad hoc coordination bodies; **2nd ARC** urged selective use with time limits.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C — CABINET COMMITTEES □

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of UPSC Traps.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: CoM strength ≤ 15% of *both Houses*

CORRECT: **≤ 15% of the Lok Sabha** (91st Amdt).

WRONG: PM must be from the Lok Sabha

CORRECT: may be from **either House** (RS PMs: Indira, Deve Gowda, Manmohan).

WRONG: Cabinet is mentioned in the original Constitution

CORRECT: inserted into **Art 352 by the 44th Amdt**; committees are **extra-constitutional**.

WRONG: Ministers can vote in both Houses

CORRECT: speak in either, **vote only in their own** (Art 88).

WRONG: CoM = Cabinet

CORRECT: CoM is the wider constitutional ministry; **Cabinet** is its smaller decision core.

WRONG: A non-MP can never be a minister/PM

CORRECT: allowed for **6 months**.

WRONG: Cabinet Committee chairs follow a permanent rule

CORRECT: composition and chairs are notification-sensitive.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced · □ CA hooks

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □□ **Anti-defection + 15% cap (91st Amdt)** stay relevant in coalition ministry formation & Speaker defection rulings. □□ **Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS)** is the apex body cited during national-security decisions (e.g. Operation Sindoor / strikes, ceasefire calls). □□ Debates on "prime-ministerial government" & concentration of power recur.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ CA hooks.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA hooks

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"Indian government has become prime-ministerial rather than cabinet government." Examine. Collective responsibility in a coalition era — is Art 75 diluted? Cabinet committees & GoMs: efficient delegation or dilution of collective decision-making?

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

HIGH

Advanced · Verified PYQ cross-link

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Verified PYQ cross-link.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

□ ***2024 GS-II Q3 (10 marks, 150 words)*** *asks how growth of the cabinet system has marginalised parliamentary supremacy. Use this file for PM/cabinet agenda control, collective responsibility and party-whip effects; use 11_Parliamentary-System.md for the complete verified-PYQ route, 17_Parliament.md for scrutiny correctives and ../basic/Ministries-and-Departments-of-Government.md for executive information, drafting, budget and departmental-control mechanisms.*

STUDY LINK

PM & Central Council of Ministers (Articles 74–75, +Cabinet Committees) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Verified PYQ cross-link

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI